NARRATIVE REPORT

Name: Joshua M. Rabulan
Year and Course: 4F3 – BSIT
Topic: RISE: Research in IT for Sustainable Excellence 2025
Speaker: Dr. Pilita A. Amahan (Plenary Speaker)
Date and Time: August 29, 2025 – 7:15 AM to 5:20 PM
Venue: Webinar hosted by Mindoro State University – Calapan City Campus

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I. Introduction
On August 29, 2025, I attended the RISE 2025: Research in IT for Sustainable Excellence. It was organized by the Research Office of Mindoro State University – Calapan City Campus and was held online through a webinar. This made it easy for students, teachers, and guests to join.
As a BSIT-4F3 student, I was excited to participate. It was not just a requirement — it was a chance to learn, see actual capstone defenses, and prepare myself for my own future project. The event focused on the idea that technology and research should help improve communities and create long-term positive impact.
The program had different parts: the morning plenary talk, parallel paper presentations, afternoon capstone defenses, and awarding. Each part taught me something new and gave me inspiration.

II. Narration of Events
Registration (7:15 AM – 7:30 AM)
I logged into the webinar early for registration. The organizers provided online attendance forms. I saw familiar names of classmates, teachers, and some alumni joining. It felt a mix of excitement and nervousness, which is normal before an academic event.
Opening Ceremony (7:30 AM – 8:00 AM)
The event officially started with welcoming remarks and introductions. The formal opening made me realize how important research is in our academic and professional growth.
Opening Remarks (8:05 AM – 8:10 AM)
Dr. Eple F. Custodio, our Program Chair, gave the opening remarks. He said that research is not just for school — it should also help society. This made me think about how I will approach my future capstone project.
Inspirational Message (8:10 AM – 8:25 AM)
Our Dean, Mr. John Edgar S. Anthony, delivered an inspirational message. He mentioned the challenges of doing research, like sleepless nights, technical issues, and many revisions. But he also said these hardships are worth it when the research creates real solutions. His message motivated me to value every step of the research process.
Plenary Session (8:30 AM – 10:00 AM)
The plenary speaker, **Dr. Pilita A. Amahan**, presented a talk called **"The Language of Images: Image Processing and How Algorithms Make Sense of Visual Data."**
I thought the topic would be difficult, but she explained it clearly. She showed how image processing is used in:

- Healthcare (medical imaging)
- Agriculture (crop monitoring)
- Security (facial recognition)
- Entertainment/social media (filters)

I was amazed that computers can "learn" to recognize images like humans. Students asked questions about privacy issues in facial recognition. Dr. Amahan reminded us that IT professionals must be responsible when using technology.
Parallel Sessions (10:15 AM – 12:00 PM)

Next, we attended parallel sessions where different groups presented their research. The topics were varied — business systems, education, health, and community-based projects. I admired the confidence of the presenters. Their defenses showed the hard work behind each study.

Afternoon Capstone Presentations (1:00 PM – 4:30 PM)

In the afternoon, the BSIT Batch 2024–2025 presented their capstone projects. Seeing them defend made me realize what we will experience next year.

Their topics included:

- Inventory and sales systems
- Healthcare-related applications
- E-learning tools
- Community projects

The presenters were professional and handled the questions well. The panelists gave constructive feedback. Watching them helped me understand what is expected in a capstone: documentation, coding, testing, and defense.

Awarding of Certificates (4:30 PM – 5:00 PM)

Certificates were given to the speakers and presenters. The students looked proud and relieved after their defenses.

Closing Remarks (5:00 PM – 5:20 PM)

Ms. Regine A. Ponce-Machete closed the event by reminding us that research does not end after submission. Its true purpose is to create meaningful and sustainable solutions.

III. Knowledge / Learning Acquired

I learned several things from the event:

1. Research must solve real problems.
2. Technical skills like image processing and algorithms are important.
3. Research must follow ethical guidelines, especially with sensitive data.
4. I learned how to properly present and defend a capstone project.
5. Teamwork is important in completing a research study.

IV. Observation

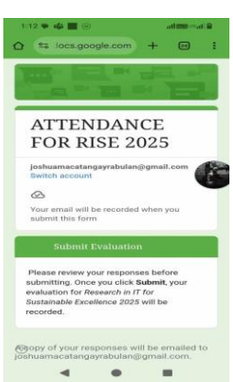
The event was well-organized even though it was online. The program flowed smoothly, and the moderators handled the event well. I felt a sense of community among students and faculty. I also observed how graduating students showed confidence and critical thinking during their defenses.

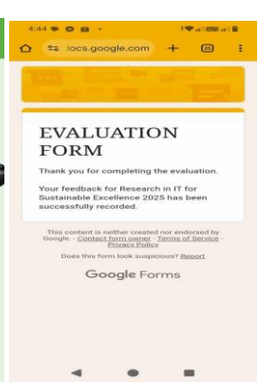
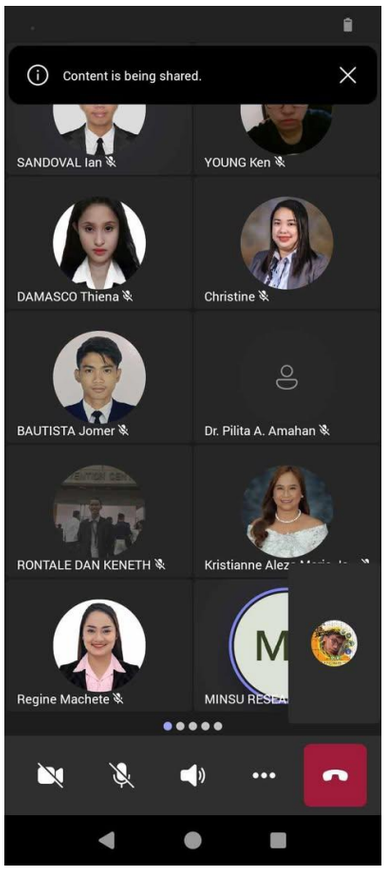
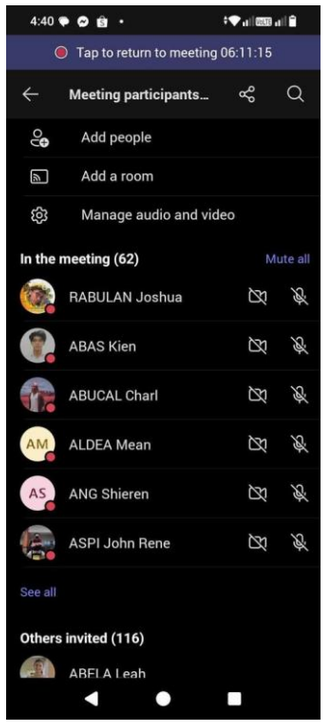
V. Recommendations / Suggestions

Here are my suggestions for future RISE events:

1. Add breakout rooms for discussions with speakers.
2. Invite alumni to share how research helped them in their careers.
3. Provide recorded sessions for review.
4. Allow lower-year students to assist as moderators.
5. Include hands-on workshops for tools, coding, and research methods.

VI. Certificate





VII. Screenshots